



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Liberia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself! You're at a key point in your life where the choices you make can really shape your future – but don't worry, there's no one “perfect” path. Since you've just finished **primary school** (in Denmark that likely means **9th or 10th grade**), you now have a few good options depending on your interests, strengths, and future goals.

Here's a breakdown of your main options in Denmark and when they might be right for you:

Danish Educational Paths After Primary School

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are 2–3-year academic programs that prepare you for **higher education** (university, professions like doctor, engineer, teacher, etc.)

Options:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – Broad academic focus. Good if you like humanities, science, or social studies.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)** – Focus on business, marketing, and economics.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)** – Focus on technology, science, and innovation.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)** – Shorter (2 years), more flexible, good if you want a quicker route to higher education.

Choose this if:

You like academic subjects, are considering university, and enjoy learning through books, projects, and exams.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education & Training - EUD)

Vocational programs that combine school and paid internships. You train for specific jobs like electrician, carpenter, health assistant, IT support, hairdresser, etc.

You can also take **EUX**, which combines vocational training with academic classes and gives access to university.

Choose this if:

You want to start working sooner, like hands-on tasks, or want to learn a trade or profession with real-world experience.

3. 10. klasse (Optional 10th Grade)

Some students take an extra year to mature, improve grades, or explore their interests before choosing a longer program.

Choose this if:

You're unsure of what to do next, need to improve your school results, or want a transition year (often with trips, group work, and focus on personal development).

How to Choose: Ask Yourself

1. **What subjects do I enjoy the most?** (Math, science, business, social studies, arts?)
2. **Do I learn best through books, discussion, or hands-on work?**
3. **Am I more interested in starting work soon, or studying more years?**
4. **Do I have any dreams or careers in mind?**

My Honest Suggestion (Based on Your Background)

Since you're fluent in Danish and have completed primary school, you have all the same opportunities as any other student in Denmark. But your Liberian heritage could also give you a unique perspective in fields like:

- **Global politics, international business, or development work** (→ consider STX or HHX)
- **Healthcare or social work**, helping diverse communities (→ HF or EUD)
- **Technology and innovation**, always in demand (→ HTX or EUD with EUX)
- **Skilled trades**, good salaries and job security (→ EUD)

If you're **not sure yet**, consider doing:

- **10th grade at an efterskole** (boarding school) – gives you time, friendships, and self-awareness.
- Then move into STX or a vocational path with more confidence.

Final Advice

Denmark gives you flexibility. Even if you choose one path, you can often **change direction later**. The most important thing is to stay curious, ask questions, and **talk to a guidance counselor (studievejleder)** – they can help based on your specific school grades, interests, and strengths.

If you want, I can help you:

- Explore a specific field (like becoming a nurse, engineer, or entrepreneur).
- Compare STX, HTX, HHX more deeply.
- Plan for university or work abroad in the future.

Would you like help with any of those?